world, amplifying possibilities exponentially while simultaneously presenting certain challenges.

Q. There's immense pressure on India and Russia especially when it comes to the sale of Russian oil to India. How can both countries handle this western pressure and sanctions?
A. The issue here is that the pressure you refer to typically involves employing political instruments to influence normal competition. Our energy cooperation with India remains unaffected by current conditions, fleeting political swings, or indeed the tragic events in Ukraine. Regarding hydrocarbons: well before the Ukrainian situation, our business entities had already built a solid and efficient commercial relationship that is based on mutual trust. It's widely known that one of our leading companies acquired an oil refinery in India—this investment represented one of the largest foreign inflows into the Indian economy, totalling more than $20 billion. Our company has been continuously expanding operations of this refinery, working with its partners, operating successfully year after year. As a result, India has become one of the major refined product suppliers to Europe—not just because it buys our oil with a discount. It took years to achieve and is in no way connected to the current economic environment. Certain actors clearly dislike India's growing role in international markets owing to its ties with Russia. Consequently, they're seeking means to constrain India's influence for political reasons by imposing artificial obstacles.

Q. In view of the sanctions by the US, the pressure they have laid on India, or the arm-twisting methods being adopted, how do you plan to circumvent all this–pull back or push harder?
A. It appears that both India and the world recognise that India cannot continue to be treated the way it was 77 years ago. India is a major global player, not a British colony, and everyone must accept this reality. Furthermore, Prime Minister Modi is not someone who succumbs to pressure easily. The Indian people can certainly take pride in their leader. His stance is unwavering and straightforward, without being confrontational. Our goal is not to provoke conflict; rather, we aim to protect our lawful rights. India does the same. When it comes to obstacles over settlements, over 90 per cent of our transactions are already conducted in national currencies. Those who attempt to hinder economic ties with third countries ultimately encounter difficulties and suffer losses. I am confident that once this perspective becomes firmly established, such tactics of applying external pressures will fade away.

Q. Has India reduced Russian intake of oil after pressure from the West?
A. Well, there is a certain decline in overall trade turnover during the first nine months of this year. This is just a minor adjustment. Overall, our trade turnover stands almost at the same level as before.



"The US still buys nuclear fuel—uranium—from Russia. If they have a right to buy our fuel, why shouldn't India have the same privilege?"

"Our energy cooperation with India remains unaffected by the events in Ukraine. Well before it, our business entities had built a solid commercial relationship based on mutual trust"

"In defence, we are not simply selling technology, we are sharing it, very rare to see in military-technical cooperation. It speaks to the level of trust between our countries and people"